

Let's collaborate to drive measurable impact together.

.....

We are committed to being a research-driven implementation organization. By combining data, expertise, and grassroots action, we create sustainable change where it matters the most.



 Roots Foundation India

 Roots Foundation

 rootsfoundation.india



ANNUAL REPORT 2025-2026

Creating measurable impact at the

Grass roots



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About Roots Foundation

Roots Foundation is a grassroots development organisation working across Sustainable Agriculture and Environment, Sports, Education, Skill Development, and Community Development.

Established with the belief that lasting change begins within communities, Roots Foundation designs and implements long-term interventions that are participatory, measurable, and rooted in local realities.

Our work focuses on strengthening systems that improve quality of life, expand opportunity, and enable communities to build sustainable futures with greater resilience and self-reliance.

Over the years, Roots Foundation has partnered with corporates, institutions, governments, and community stakeholders to implement programs across multiple states in India, with a strong emphasis on execution, accountability, and measurable outcomes.

Message From The Founders

At Roots Foundation, we have always believed that meaningful change begins at the grassroots. This year reaffirmed that belief as communities increasingly became active participants in shaping and strengthening the programs implemented alongside them.

Our focus has always been on creating programs that last beyond timelines and funding cycles. We invest time in building trust with communities and partners, understanding local realities, and designing implementation models that can sustain and grow over time. When communities take ownership, impact continues well beyond the duration of a project.

Transparency, accountability, and continuous learning remain central to how we measure and improve our work. Across our programs, we continue to strengthen collaboration with local administrations, institutions, and ecosystem partners to support long-term continuity and adoption.

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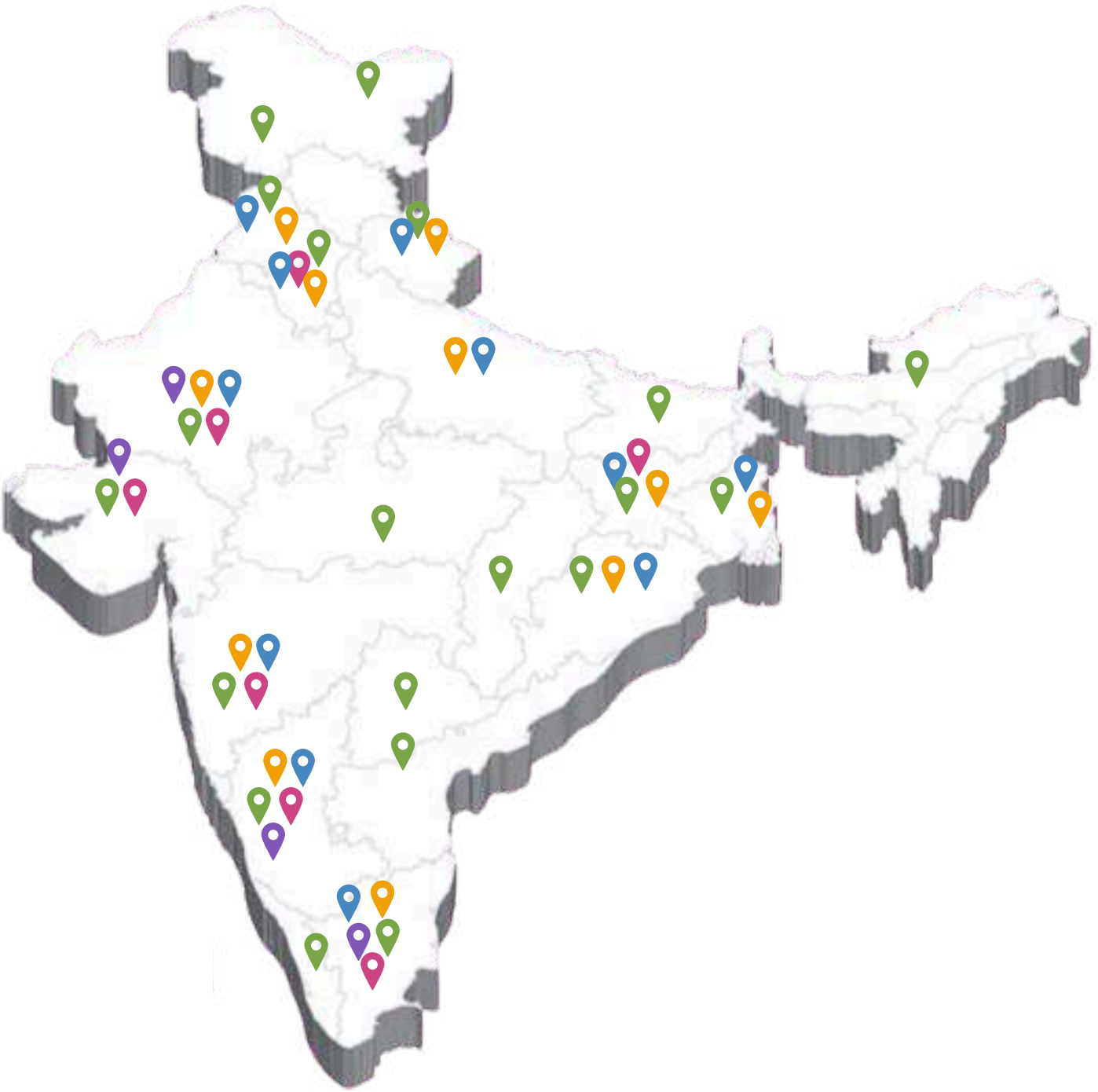
As Roots Foundation continues to grow, our commitment remains unchanged: to build programs that create measurable impact, strengthen local systems, and enable communities to shape their own progress with confidence and dignity.

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Ridhima & Ritwik Bahuguna
Founders, Roots Foundation



Our impact by focus areas



-  Agriculture and Environment
-  Sports and Physical Literacy
-  Community Development
-  Education and Career Rediness
-  Skill Development



AGRICULTURE AND ENVIRONMENT
Building Circular, Climate-Ready Farm Systems



SPORTS AND PHYSICAL LITERACY
Creating Grassroots Pathways to Sporting Excellence



SKILL DEVELOPMENT
Linking Skills, Production and Livelihoods



EDUCATION AND CAREER READINESS
Strengthening Learning Pathways for Every Child



COMMUNITY DEVELOPMENT
Creating Access Where Communities Need It the Most

OUR JOURNEY

Founded in 2012, Roots Foundation began with a simple conviction that lasting change must start from the grassroots.

What started as a small, founder-funded initiative has evolved into a multi-sector organisation working across agriculture and environment, education, sports, skill development, and community development.

Over the years, Roots Foundation has steadily expanded its reach across sectors and geographies, working alongside communities to strengthen local systems, support sustainable livelihoods, and build long-term development programs rooted in participation and continuity.





Our Mission

To enable individuals and communities to build stronger livelihoods and better futures through focused interventions in agriculture, sports, education, skilling and community development.

Our Vision

To create lasting community-level change by strengthening opportunities, capabilities and systems that help people thrive.

Rooted In Impact

At Roots Foundation, impact is built through participation, continuity, and local ownership. Our programs are designed with communities, grounded in local realities, and implemented through long-term engagement.

Across sectors, we focus on strengthening systems that can sustain beyond the lifecycle of a project, whether through behaviour change, institutional partnerships, local capacity building, community development or livelihood creation.

This approach shapes all our work:

Creating structured pathways in grassroots sports	Strengthening learning environments in schools	Improving quality of life through integrated community development
Supporting climate-resilient agriculture through farmer-led adoption	Connecting skilling with real livelihood opportunities	Advancing water conservation through lake rejuvenation and ecological restoration

Sustainable Development Goals

The Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) provide a shared global framework to address poverty, inequality, climate change, access to education, health, livelihoods, and sustainable development.

At Roots Foundation, our programs align with these goals through long-term, community-led interventions across agriculture and environment, sports, education, skilling, and community development.

From strengthening climate-resilient farming systems and improving access to education, to creating livelihood opportunities and supporting grassroots sports ecosystems, our work contributes to multiple interconnected SDGs across people, planet, and prosperity.

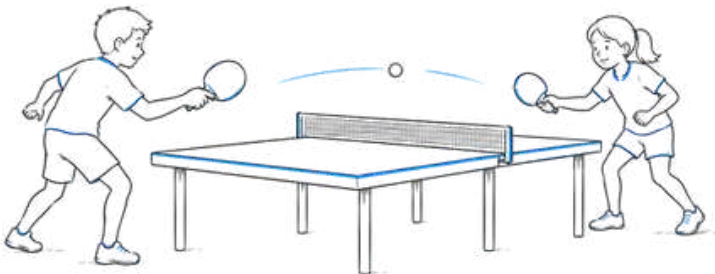


Agriculture and Environment



Crop residue management (in-situ and ex-situ), direct seeding of rice, crop diversification, agroforestry, farmer field schools, soil health improvement, biodiversity conservation, water-efficient practices, and market linkages for residue management that support climate-resilient agriculture.

Sports and Physical Literacy



Grassroots sports programs, centres of excellence, talent scouting in remote regions, school and community leagues, sports-specific training, fitness and nutrition support, advocacy for equal opportunities, and structured pathways for young athletes from underserved communities.

Skill Development



8
DECENT WORK AND ECONOMIC GROWTH

5
GENDER EQUALITY

10
REDUCED INEQUALITIES

12
RESPONSIBLE CONSUMPTION AND PRODUCTION

9
INDUSTRY, INNOVATION AND INFRASTRUCTURE



Market-linked skilling, artisan and women-led production systems, employee volunteer workshops, flexible training models for sole-earning women, and livelihood pathways that support dignified economic participation. The program also promotes circular economy approaches by using agricultural and factory waste, including parali and fabric waste, to create environmentally conscious end products.

Education and Career Readiness



4
QUALITY EDUCATION

5
GENDER EQUALITY



Foundational literacy and numeracy, STEM and digital learning, life skills, career guidance, teacher and SDMC capacity building, promotion of sports and co-curricular learning, library ecosystems, and improved school engagement for children and adolescents.

Community Development



1
NO POVERTY

3
GOOD HEALTH AND WELL-BEING

6
CLEAN WATER AND SANITATION

11
SUSTAINABLE CITIES AND COMMUNITIES

16
PEACE, JUSTICE AND STRONG INSTITUTIONS



10
REDUCED INEQUALITIES

Rural healthcare access, scholarships, digital literacy, sanitation, community infrastructure, disability inclusion, mobility support, water conservation, lake rejuvenation, local participation platforms, and initiatives that improve everyday quality of life in rural communities.

Partnerships and Monitoring

17
PARTNERSHIPS FOR THE GOALS

Long-term CSR partnerships, collaboration with local administrations and institutions, independent third-party assessments, monitoring and evaluation systems, documentation, and ecosystem-based implementation approaches that strengthen transparency, accountability, and continuity.

Agriculture and Environment

Across regions, our work combines farmer engagement, field demonstrations, mechanisation support, ecosystem partnerships, and capacity building to strengthen the adoption of sustainable agricultural practices.



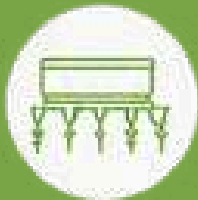
Roots Foundation’s agriculture and environment programs enable large-scale adoption of climate-resilient farming practices by combining farmer engagement, mechanisation support, field demonstrations, and ecosystem linkages that strengthen resource efficiency and long-term rural livelihoods.

Addressing Environmental and Economic Challenges

Our programs are designed to address both environmental and economic challenges through key sustainable approaches.



Crop Residue Management (CRM)



Direct Seeding of Rice (DSR)



Crop Diversification



Agroforestry and Afforestation



Farmer-led Service Ecosystems

The focus is on enabling long-term adoption by strengthening local systems, improving access to knowledge, technology and machinery, and building stronger linkages between farmers, institutions, service providers and end-user industries. These efforts also promote reduced carbon emissions, responsible resource use, soil health and ecological restoration, supporting more sustainable and climate-resilient agricultural practices.

Focus Areas



Crop residue management (CRM)



Direct seeding of rice (DSR)



Climate-resilient agriculture



Farm mechanisation and entrepreneurship



Soil health and water-efficient practices



Farmer capacity building and field demonstrations



Farmer field schools and ecosystem engagement



Market and end-user industry linkages



Agri allied activities

Agriculture Snapshot

2,00,000+

Acres brought under Crop Residue Management enabling large-scale prevention of stubble burning.

4,00,000+

Tonnes of paddy residue sustainably managed through ecosystem-led interventions.

50,000+

Farmers reached and sensitised via campaigns, field demonstrations, and ecosystem engagement.

5.5 Lakh

Tonnes of CO2 emissions avoided equivalent to removing ~1.25 lakh cars from roads annually.

35%+

Reduced methane (CH4) emissions per acre achieved through direct seeded rice (DSR) compared to traditional methods.

120 B Litres

Irrigation water saved through successful DSR adoption across multiple regions..

240

Demonstration plots successfully validated DSR adoption across Haryana.

64

Boom sprayers deployed under Project Sahyog across four states.

27,760

Acres covered through mechanised spraying improving timeliness and precision.

20,000+

Labour-hours saved reducing drudgery and improving operational efficiency.

100+

Rural agri preneurs identified and enabled creating decentralised farm service ecosystems.

14+

End User Industry (EUI) linkages established strengthening market connections and value chains.



PROJECT BHOOMI, HARYANA

Project Bhoomi Haryana focuses on reducing crop residue burning and strengthening climate-resilient agricultural practices across fatehabad, jind, hisar, and sonipat districts of Haryana.

The program combines Direct Seeding of Rice (DSR), crop residue management (CRM), farmer sensitisation, stakeholder engagement, and ecosystem linkages to support long-term behavioural change and sustainable farming adoption.

Key Interventions

- **Direct Seeding of Rice (DSR) Promotion:** Establishment of 240+ demonstration plots across districts, supported by soil testing, field-level advisory, and farmer handholding to validate cost-effective and scalable alternatives to traditional paddy cultivation.
- **Crop Residue Management (CRM) Ecosystem Enablement:** Large-scale farmer sensitisation and linkage with service providers, machinery operators, and end-user industries to enable in-situ and ex-situ residue management across districts.
- **Behaviour Change & Farmer Engagement:** Intensive village-level campaigns, demonstrations, and continuous engagement to shift farmer practices away from burning towards sustainable alternatives.
- **Ecosystem & Market Linkages:** Integration of farmers with service providers, FPOs, agricultural departments, and end-user industries to create a functional and scalable residue management value chain.



Highlights & Outcomes



Direct Seeding of Rice (DSR) validated as a scalable and profitable alternative, with demonstration plots delivering 35% higher income



Adoption pipeline established, with **300+** farmers adopting DSR and **1,500+** farmers identified for scale-up in the next season



30,000+ farmers enabled with access to Crop Residue Management (CRM) solutions, linking them to service providers and viable alternatives to burning



District-level CRM value chain activated, integrating **8 End User Industries (EUIs)** for large-scale residue utilisation



36,000+ farmers influenced through structured behaviour change campaigns, contributing to reduction in fire-prone practices across intervention areas



Integrated CRM ecosystem operationalised across **4 districts**, aligning farmers, machinery providers, institutions and markets into a scalable system





PROJECT BHOOMI, KOTA

Project Bhoomi Kota focuses on developing local entrepreneurship models for crop residue management and sustainable mechanisation practices in Rajasthan, with a unique focus on both the Kharif and Rabi cycles. The program is designed to address the critical gap in Rabi residue management, where burning remains largely unaddressed. The initiative works towards building a self-sustaining ecosystem where rural youth and farmers can access machinery, residue utilisation networks, and livelihood opportunities linked to sustainable agricultural practices.

Key Interventions

- **Kharif CRM Awareness & System Preparation:** Farmer sensitisation and ecosystem groundwork to prepare villages for structured residue management interventions
- **Rural Agripreneurship Development for CRM Services:** Identification and onboarding of local entrepreneurs to enable machinery-led service delivery
- **Mechanisation Enablement & Demonstration:** Introduction of Super Seeders, Zero Till Seeders, and balers in regions with minimal existing infrastructure
- **Rabi CRM Awareness & Behaviour Change Campaigns:** Targeted engagement to address the largely ignored Rabi burning cycle and build early adoption
- **Fire Season Response:** Activation of on-ground systems during the burning season to enable real-time intervention and demonstrate alternatives
- **Local CRM Ecosystem Creation:** Establishment of residue utilisation linkages with gaushalas, biomass units, and local traders
- **Farmer Engagement & Behaviour Change:** Direct farmer outreach to initiate adoption and build long-term behavioural shifts

Highlights & Outcomes



First-of-its-kind dual-season **CRM model** initiated, addressing both Kharif preparedness and the largely neglected Rabi burning cycle



46 rural agripreneurs identified to anchor last-mile service delivery, forming the foundation for a decentralised mechanisation model



Mechanisation introduced in low-infrastructure geographies, enabling first-time access to residue management solutions at village level like Balers and Superseeders



Fire-season interventions initiated during Rabi cycle, demonstrating practical alternatives to burning in real-time field conditions



1,700+ farmers directly engaged, building early awareness, trust, and adoption momentum across villages



Residue utilisation pathways established, with gaushalas, traders, and biomass units integrated into the ecosystem





PROJECT SAHYOG

Project Sahyog is a precision agriculture and farm mechanisation initiative implemented across haryana, punjab, uttar pradesh, and uttarakhand. The program strengthens access to mechanised spraying systems while promoting safe agrochemical practices, entrepreneurship, and rental-based service models for farmers and rural institutions.

Key Interventions

- **Precision Spraying Infrastructure Deployment:** Deployment of Tractor-Mounted Sprayers (TMS) and Self-Propelled Boom Sprayers (SPBS) to enable efficient, large-scale spraying
- **Agripreneurship & Rental Model Enablement:** Identification of entrepreneurial farmers, FPOs, cooperatives, and institutions to operate as service providers
- **Farmer Engagement & Field Demonstrations:** Engagement through demonstrations, FGDs, trainings, and awareness campaigns to build trust and drive adoption of mechanised spraying
- **Safe Agrochemical Use & Capacity Building:** Training on calibrated spraying, dosage optimisation, and safe handling practices
- **Mechanisation-led Service Delivery Systems:** Establishment of rental-based models to provide affordable and timely spraying services to small and marginal farmers

Highlights & Outcomes



64 boom sprayers deployed across Haryana, Punjab, Uttar Pradesh, and Uttarakhand, establishing a distributed precision spraying network at scale



27,760 acres covered through mechanised spraying in a single season



1,818 farmers directly accessed mechanised spraying services, reducing dependence on manual labour and high-cost alternatives



15,000+ farmers reached through demonstrations, focus group discussions, and awareness activities



Video tutorials and operational training provided to all machine beneficiaries for long-term usage support



Rental-based agripreneur model operationalised, enabling farmers and institutions to generate income through service delivery



Safe agrochemical practices promoted at scale, improving input efficiency and reducing overuse and health risks



20,000+ labour-hours saved, reducing drudgery and improving operational efficiency



~150 workers safeguarded from direct agrochemical exposure



Sports and Physical Literacy

Roots Foundation’s sports programs focus on creating structured pathways that enable children and young athletes to access training, mentorship, competitive exposure, and long-term development opportunities.



Across schools, communities, and centres of excellence, our programs work to strengthen grassroots participation, improve access to organised sports, and support athlete progression through ecosystem-based interventions. The approach combines physical literacy, coaching support, counselling, fitness and nutrition, talent scouting, sports science, parent engagement, and institutional partnerships to build sustainable sporting environments for children and youth.

The focus remains on creating continuity in athlete development while ensuring that children from rural, tribal, and underserved urban and semi-urban communities have access to opportunities that support both sporting and personal growth.

Our Focus

Creating continuity in athlete development while ensuring that children from rural, tribal, and underserved communities have access to opportunities that support both sporting and personal growth.



Reaching rural, tribal and underserved communities



Ensuring continuity in athlete development pathways



Enabling holistic growth through sport and life skills

Focus Areas



Grassroots sports promotion & participation



Structured athlete development pathways



Talent scouting & identification



School and community sports ecosystems



Centres of Excellence & residential training



Fitness, nutrition & sports science support



Coach development & mentorship



Parent & community engagement



Competitive exposure & athlete progression

Sports Snapshot

10,000+

children engaged across grassroots sports programs, school initiatives, leagues, and athlete development pathways.

Structured

sports programs implemented across schools, villages, and Centres of Excellence.

Multi-sport

engagement across athletics, football, badminton, table-tennis, cricket, kho-kho, and other disciplines.

5,000+

students reached through scouting initiatives across 450+ schools and 6 blocks under Project Utkarsh.

Residential

athlete development and progression pathways supported for selected athletes under Project Utkarsh.

Centres of Excellence

established under Sports Lab to support structured athlete development and long-term training ecosystems.

181

students engaged across three schools under Sports for All, with progression into state and national-level competitions.

450+

Schools

and 6 blocks covered through scouting initiatives.

Pathways

Building a strong pipeline from grassroots to elite-level opportunities.



SPORTS LAB

Sports Lab is Roots Foundation’s long-term athlete development initiative designed to strengthen grassroots sports ecosystems through structured training environments, Centres of Excellence, sports science integration, and athlete progression pathways. The program works with young athletes, coaches, schools, and communities to create sustained engagement in sport while supporting physical development, competitive readiness, and long-term participation.

Key Interventions

- Establishment of Centres of Excellence for structured athlete development
- Athlete scouting and assessment processes
- Sports-specific coaching and training programs
- Integration of fitness, nutrition, recovery, and sports science support
- Parent engagement and athlete counselling sessions
- School and community-level engagement activities
- Monitoring and digital athlete tracking systems



Highlights & Outcomes



Centres of Excellence operationalised to support structured athlete pathways



Athlete engagement programs conducted with schools, communities, and ecosystem partners



Parent engagement initiatives strengthened communication between athletes, coaches, and families



Fitness, nutrition, and performance-focused support integrated into athlete development systems



Structured systems introduced to support continuity in athlete training and progression





SEHATGIRI

Sehatgiri is Roots Foundation's community wellness initiative that promotes healthy lifestyles through physical activity, preventive healthcare, and nutrition awareness. The programme encourages people of all age groups to adopt active lifestyles while strengthening community participation in health and fitness.

Key Interventions

- Community fitness sessions.
- Wellness and health awareness campaigns.
- Preventive health initiatives.
- Physical activity promotion.
- Community engagement events.



Highlights & Outcomes



Reached **4,000+** community members across urban gurugram in under served communities.



Conducted **22+** wellness and fitness events.



Increased awareness of preventive healthcare and healthy lifestyles.



Promoted regular physical activity and community well-being.



Encouraged healthier lifestyle choices through community engagement.





GRASSROOTS SPORTS DEVELOPMENT

ANUKURA is the flagship CSR sports initiative of Mahanadi Coalfields Limited (MCL), implemented by Roots Foundation in partnership with the District Administration, Mayurbhanj, Odisha. The programme aims to strengthen the grassroots sports ecosystem by promoting physical fitness, identifying sporting talent, and creating structured athlete development pathways for rural children and youth.

Key Interventions

- Implemented across 30 Government Schools.
- Covering Baripada, Thakurmunda, and Moroda blocks.
- Establishing 12 Sports Training Centres across 48 villages.
- Developing 2 Centres of Excellence (CoEs).
- Scientific fitness assessments.
- Talent identification camps.
- Morning fitness programmes.
- Structured coaching.
- Career guidance and community engagement.



Highlights & Outcomes



Reaching **3,600+** children and youth.



Expanded access to quality sports coaching across rural communities.



Established a structured grassroots sports ecosystem.



Created athlete pathways towards district, state and national competitions



Promoted lifelong fitness, sporting excellence, and community participation.





SPORTS FOR ALL

Sports for All focuses on increasing access to organised sports participation among school-going children through structured school engagement, coaching support, competitions, and physical literacy programs. The initiative works closely with schools, students, and local stakeholders to strengthen sports participation while supporting confidence, teamwork, discipline, and school engagement among children.

Key Interventions

- School-based sports coaching and engagement
- Grassroots competitions and tournament participation
- Physical literacy and fitness-focused activities
- Identification of promising athletes for higher-level participation
- Engagement with teachers, schools, and local communities
- Promotion of equal participation opportunities for girls and underserved children



Highlights & Outcomes



181 unique students participated across three schools under the program



37 students advanced to state-level competitions



3 students advanced to national-level competitions



19 gold, **4** silver, **6** bronze medals secured across competitions



Participation enabled through platforms **including SGFI National School Games and KKFI National Kho-Kho Championship.**





VILLAGE CHAMPIONS LEAGUE

Village Champions League (VCL) is an innovative grassroots sports league designed to improve school attendance, youth leadership, and community participation through structured competitive sports. By integrating education with sport, VCL creates sustained engagement among students while promoting teamwork, discipline, and leadership.

Key Interventions

- Structured Football and Kabaddi leagues.
- Attendance-linked participation.
- Community mobilisation.
- Leadership and life-skills development.
- Sports incentives and recognition.



Highlights & Outcomes



330+ students participated.



Covered **8** Government Schools across **6** villages.



Formed **16 teams**.



Conducted **138** competitive matches.



Created a prize pool of **₹13.18 lakh**.



Improved school attendance by **10.5%**.



Strengthened community participation and youth leadership through sport.





PROJECT UTKARSH

Project Utkarsh focuses on identifying and supporting sporting talent from rural and tribal communities through structured scouting, residential training support, mentorship, and competitive exposure. The program is designed to create long-term athlete development pathways for children who often have limited access to organised sports infrastructure and training opportunities.

Key Interventions

- Large-scale talent scouting across schools and rural communities
- Athlete selection and residential training support
- Sports-specific coaching and competitive preparation
- Integration of education, counselling, nutrition, and mentorship
- Exposure visits and participation in district, state, and national competitions
- Continuous athlete monitoring and progression support



Highlights & Outcomes



5,000 students reached through scouting across **450+** schools and **6** blocks



100 students selected for advanced support and structured athlete development



13 students progressed to higher Centres of Excellence



Athletes participated in district, state, and **national-level** competitions across football, hockey, and athletics



Structured support provided through coaching, nutrition, physiotherapy, counselling, education continuity, and exposure opportunities.



Skill Development

Roots Foundation’s skilling programs focus on creating livelihood pathways that combine practical training, production-based learning, and long-term economic participation for women and youth.



Market-Linked Training
Courses designed with local needs & industry insights to build relevant skills.



Hands-on Learning
Practical, flexible & accessible learning environments.



Real Production Connection
Training linked to real production systems & livelihood opportunities.



Industry Engagement
Strong linkages with industry for exposure, internships, and orders.



Livelihood & Empowerment
Enhanced employability, confidence, & financial independence.

The programs are designed to strengthen employability, confidence, and financial independence through market-linked training models that respond to local realities and evolving livelihood opportunities. Across initiatives, the focus remains on creating accessible and flexible learning environments while connecting training directly with real production systems, industry engagement, and livelihood generation.

Through partnerships with brands, organisations, and industry stakeholders, the programs also create opportunities for women artisans and trainees to participate in professional production processes, workshops, and collaborative projects.



Focus Areas



Women-led livelihood programs



Market-linked skilling



Production-based learning models



Artisan development and quality systems



Textile and embroidery training



Flexible learning and work environments



Industry and brand collaborations



Employment & entrepreneurship pathways



Unnati skilling center

Skilling Snapshot

Livelihood & skilling programs

implemented for women and youth across community settings.

Training provided

in sewing, embroidery, textile-based production, and related skills.

Production-linked work opportunities

enabled through industry and brand collaborations.

Rs 11.5 lakhs

worth of work orders secured through production partnerships.

Collaborations undertaken

with brands and organisations including dressfolk, Amala Earth, Saffron House, Raghavendra Rathore, Aseem Design Studio, and Skinvest.

Employee engagement

and artisan-led workshops conducted through hands-on production and design activities.



PROJECT UNNATI

Project Unnati focuses on strengthening livelihood opportunities for women through skill development, production-based learning, and industry-linked engagement in textiles and embroidery. The Unnati Centre was also established, marking a dedicated step towards women-led skilling, livelihood creation, and production-linked training.

The program creates accessible training and work environments that support women in building practical skills while participating in real production systems and collaborative projects. Alongside technical training, the initiative focuses on confidence-building, financial independence, and long-term livelihood continuity.

Key Interventions

- Training in sewing, hand embroidery, machine embroidery, and textile production
- Production-linked learning through live work orders and collaborative projects
- Quality control and production management exposure for trainees
- Industry and brand collaborations for product development and execution
- Flexible work and learning models designed around local realities and responsibilities
- Employee engagement workshops included hands-on sessions where employees engaged with trainees, learned about production processes, and participated in activities related to textile work, upcycling, embroidery, and product creation.



Highlights & Outcomes



₹11.5 lakh worth of work orders secured through collaborative production projects



Women are increasingly engaged in in-house production opportunities linked to the centre



Collaborative production and engagement initiatives undertaken with multiple independent brands and design studios



Exposure to quality control, product finishing, and production workflows integrated into training systems



Artisan-led workshops conducted with organisations and employee groups through hands-on learning experiences



Participant Journeys



Poonam
Tiwari

Poonam Tiwari progressed from trainee to production team member through her involvement in embroidery and collaborative order execution at the centre. She also contributed to quality control processes during the Skinvest production project, strengthening both technical and operational skills.



Rannu
Devi

Through training in Adda embroidery and continued engagement with the centre, Rannu Devi developed advanced embroidery skills while rebuilding confidence and financial stability during a period of personal and family challenges.



Divya
Kumari

Divya Kumari strengthened her technical and professional skills through portfolio development & training support, eventually progressing toward formal employment opportunities while continuing to support long-term aspirations for herself & her family.



PROJECT PARALI

The Parali Project supports women from Self-Help Groups (SHGs) in creating marketable products from paddy residue at our unnati centre and multiple other locations. The initiative promotes circular economy practices by converting agricultural waste into environmentally conscious end products, while enabling women to build new skills, explore supplementary income opportunities, and participate in sustainable production systems.

Through training, product development, and market linkage support, the initiative connects crop residue management with women-led livelihood creation.



Education and Career Readiness



Roots Foundation’s education programs focus on strengthening learning environments through foundational learning, adolescent development, school engagement, and holistic support systems for children and young people.

Across schools and communities, the programs work towards improving learning outcomes, confidence, retention, life skills, and access to meaningful educational opportunities. The approach combines foundational literacy and numeracy, science technology engineering and mathematics (STEM) and digital learning, counselling support, career guidance, teacher engagement, and co-curricular development to create more inclusive and supportive learning ecosystems.



Foundational literacy and numeracy



STEM and digital learning



Mental health and career counselling support



Health and hygiene infrastructure support and sensitization



Teacher engagement and capacity building



Co-curricular development and equipment support

The focus is on helping children and adolescents participate more confidently in education, while strengthening the systems and support structures that contribute to their learning and overall development.



Focus Areas



Foundational literacy and numeracy (FLN)



STEM & digital learning



Adolescent development & life skills



Career guidance and counselling



Teacher & school ecosystem strengthening



Holistic learning environments



School engagement and retention



Sports and co-curricular participation



Community and institutional engagement

Education Snapshot

3 Major

targeted and structured education programs implemented across schools and community learning environments

Foundational Learning

and adolescent development initiatives conducted through school-based interventions

STEM, Digital Learning and Life Skills

engagement integrated into education programs

Counselling, Mentorship and Career Guidance

support provided for adolescents and students

Teacher Engagement & School Ecosystem Strengthening

supported through training and institutional collaboration across 22 low-income private and government schools in 5 cities, 4 states

Focus on

improving participation, confidence, retention, and long-term learning continuity for children and adolescents

Strengthening the Future

enabling children and adolescents to build skills, aspiration, and opportunities for a better tomorrow





PROJECT LEAP

LEAP focuses on adolescent development through structured interventions in life skills, counselling, career guidance, leadership development, and school engagement. The program works with adolescents in school settings to strengthen confidence, communication, decision-making, and preparedness for future educational and personal pathways. Alongside group sessions and school engagement, the initiative provides individual counselling and support systems for students who require additional guidance.

Key Interventions

- Life-skills and leadership development sessions
- Career guidance and future-readiness workshops
- Financial literacy and communication sessions
- One-on-one counselling and psychosocial support
- Capacity building, infrastructure improvement, and literacy-building engagement with schools, teachers, and local stakeholders
- Adolescent-focused workshops to strengthen confidence, participation, and self-awareness



Highlights & Outcomes

-  **170+** life-skills and leadership development sessions conducted
-  **90+** workshops facilitated for career guidance and future readiness
-  **200+** financial literacy and communication workshops conducted
-  One-on-one counselling and psychosocial support extended to **8,300+** students
-  Structured engagement conducted across **22** schools, including work with teachers and local stakeholders
-  **50+** adolescent-focused workshops conducted to strengthen confidence and participation
-  **Counselling support** systems established to address student wellbeing and individual guidance needs
-  **Career awareness** & preparedness activities conducted for adolescents transitioning into higher education & future pathways
-  **Strengthened focus** on confidence building, participation, and long-term personal development





PROJECT SCHOOL TRANSFORMATION

The Stellantis School Transformation Project focuses on strengthening school ecosystems through foundational learning, STEM education, infrastructure support, and improved learning environments with a special focus on the girl child. The program works across partner schools to improve foundational literacy and numeracy, strengthen access to learning resources, and create supportive school environments that encourage participation, retention, and long-term educational engagement.

Key Interventions

- Foundational literacy and numeracy (FLN) assessments and interventions
- STEM learning through set up science labs, experienced STEM trainers and digital learning engagement
- School infrastructure and learning environment support
- Teacher and school ecosystem engagement
- Support for girl child education and participation
- Portable STEM learning systems and activity-based learning approaches



Highlights & Outcomes

-  Baseline evaluations completed across **13 partner schools** to assess foundational learning levels and learning gaps
-  **FLN-focused** interventions across **4 schools** initiated to strengthen reading, comprehension, and foundational learning outcomes
-  **All four schools** for the FLN intervention are equipped with state-of-the-art digital infrastructure and customised digital FLN teaching modules
-  **10 STEM labs** set up through permanent and portable models along with activity-based learning systems
-  Focus on strengthening **participation and learning** continuity for girls through improved school environments
-  **Teacher engagement** and ecosystem strengthening integrated into implementation planning and delivery





PROJECT SCHOOL TRANSFORMATION WITH SPECIAL FOCUS ON EMPOWERING THE GIRL CHILD

A school transformation initiative in Hosur, Tamil Nadu, focused on improving foundational learning, STEM education, and school infrastructure for over 3,000 underprivileged children, with a special emphasis on empowering girls and students from Scheduled Caste and Scheduled Tribe communities.

Key Interventions

- Implemented across 13 government schools in Thally and Kelamangalam blocks, Hosur.
- Benefiting 3,000+ students, with a special focus on girls and tribal communities.
- Establishing 3 Innovative Learning Centres (ILCs) to strengthen foundational literacy and numeracy.
- Setting up 10 STEM Labs to promote experiential science and technology education.
- Upgrading school infrastructure, including toilets and essential facilities, to improve hygiene, safety, and school retention.
- Delivering structured programmes in functional English, Mathematics, STEM, sanitation, and hygiene.



Highlights & Outcomes

-  Improved foundational literacy, numeracy, and STEM learning among students.
-  Increased access to technology-enabled and experiential education.
-  Enhanced school infrastructure, contributing to better attendance and retention of girl students.
-  Reduced educational barriers for underserved children from Scheduled Caste and Scheduled Tribe communities.
-  Created safer, more inclusive, and equitable learning environments that support long-term educational success.



Community Development

Roots Foundation’s community development programs focus on strengthening everyday systems that improve the quality of life across rural and underserved communities.

The approach combines healthcare access, infrastructure support, digital literacy, education assistance, livelihood initiatives, and community participation to address interconnected local needs through long-term engagement. Programs are designed to strengthen local ecosystems while improving access to essential services, public spaces, and opportunities for individuals and families.

Across geographies, the focus remains on building practical, community-centred interventions that support continuity, participation, and local ownership.



Healthcare Access
Improving access to quality healthcare & essential health services.



Infrastructure Support
Enhancing infrastructure and public spaces for safer, healthier communities.



Digital Literacy
Building digital skills and enabling access to technology & information.



Education Assistance
Supporting learning opportunities and academic growth for children and youth.



Livelihood Initiatives
Creating sustainable livelihood opportunities and strengthening economic resilience.



Community Participation
Encouraging active community involvement and local leadership for lasting impact.



Focus Areas



Rural healthcare access



Community infrastructure development



Scholarships and education support



Digital literacy and community learning



Livelihood and self-help group engagement



Disability inclusion and mobility support



Public space and environmental restoration



Community participation and local systems strengthening



Maternal health and family welfare

Community Development Snapshot

Karnataka & Tamil Nadu

Community development programs implemented across Karnataka and Tamil Nadu.

Rural Integrated

Rural healthcare, infrastructure, and livelihood interventions conducted through integrated community engagement.

Community Clinics: 2

Healthcare consultations, preventive care, and wellness support enabled through 2 major rural community clinics in Polanahalli and Cheemachanahalli, Karnataka.

30 Students

Scholarships to 30 deserving students from socially vulnerable backgrounds, along with digital literacy and community learning initiatives supported across intervention regions.

Community Participation

Community participation and environmental sustainability integrated through local engagement, committees, and stakeholder coordination.

32.5 Acres

Successful rejuvenation of a 32.5-acre lake, restoring its ecological and functional value.

2 KM Road

Renovation of a ~2 km road from Kallupalli Gate to Atthipalli Main Road that benefits commute for approximately 5000 daily commuters.

Public Infrastructure

Public infrastructure and ecological restoration projects implemented to strengthen long-term community access and usability.





COMMUNITY DEVELOPMENT INITIATIVE

The Devanahalli Community Development Initiative focuses on strengthening access to healthcare, education support, digital learning, livelihoods, and basic community infrastructure across rural communities in Karnataka. The program works through integrated interventions designed to improve everyday quality of life while supporting long-term community participation and local engagement.

Key Interventions

- Rural healthcare and preventive care support through community clinics
- Scholarships and educational support initiatives
- Digital literacy and community learning activities
- Livelihood and self-help group engagement
- Community infrastructure support including lighting and public-use facilities
- Disability inclusion and mobility assistance initiatives



Highlights & Outcomes

- Improved access to education for **30 students** through scholarship support
- Strengthened community healthcare through 2 fully equipped, functional clinics with hired resources (doctors and nurse) to provide daily healthcare services to Devanhalli Taluk region, Karnataka
- Enhanced rural livelihoods and livestock health via 6 animal camps
- Enabled mobility and independence for 8 persons with disabilities
- Created lasting community assets through a community center and high mast light installation
- Promoted environmental sustainability through plantation initiatives
- Enhanced youth employability through introduction of VR-based skill training modules at GTTC college
- Supply and installation of a 12-meter high mast lighting system at Chanahalli





PROJECT LAKE REJUVENATION AND COMMUNITY INFRASTRUCTURE

The Hosur initiative focuses on ecological restoration and community infrastructure development through the rejuvenation of public spaces and improved environmental systems.

The project combines lake restoration, public infrastructure improvement, accessibility measures, and community engagement to strengthen environmental sustainability and public usability within the intervention area.

Key Interventions

- Lake rejuvenation and ecological restoration activities
- Strengthening of water systems and surrounding infrastructure
- Development of accessible public-use spaces
- Installation of lighting, pathways, and safety infrastructure
- Community engagement and coordination with local stakeholders



Highlights & Outcomes



Successful rejuvenation of a **32.5-acre** lake, restoring its ecological and functional value



Creation of a safe and accessible public space through a walkable pathway, solar lighting, and CCTV surveillance



Improvement in water quality and support to groundwater recharge



Enhanced community usage and engagement, benefiting **~10,000** residents



Completion of a **~2 km** road from Kallupalli Gate to Atthipalli Main Road



Significant improvement in connectivity, reducing travel time and easing heavy traffic flow



Safer and more reliable commuting experience for **~1,00,000** road users



Integrated approach linking environmental restoration with infrastructure development for wider community impact



Media & Recognition



25+
News Publications



50+
Media Mentions



50K+
People Reached



Widespread
Coverage Across Print,
Digital & Broadcast Media



The CSR Universe
Building Bridges to Quality Education: How Roots Foundation is Strengthening Learning Outcomes Through Project Utkarsh



Green advocacy | Roots Foundation launches awareness campaign on proper application of agrochemicals



businessline.
Roots Foundation and PI Industries Collaborate for Project Sahyog in UP, Punjab, Haryana and Uttarakhand



हरिभूमि
अच्छी पैदावार के लिए फसल विविधिकरण अपनाए किसान



गोष्ठी में जमीन की उर्वरा शक्ति बढ़ाने के लिए टिप्स



INDIA TODAY
Bengal Chamber recognises excellence in CSR at its CSR Conclave & Social Leadership Awards



businessline.
Roots Foundation, PI Industries initiate 'Project Sahyog'



गोष्ठी में जमीन की उर्वरा शक्ति बढ़ाने के लिए टिप्स



The Telegraph online
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The Telegraph online
my KOLKATA

Governance



Ethical Governance Framework

Roots Foundation operates as a registered Society and Section 8 entity with clearly defined structures, ensuring adherence to statutory, financial, and operational compliance standards.



Board & Leadership Oversight

Strategic oversight is exercised through leadership-led reviews, ensuring alignment of programs with organisational mission, stakeholder expectations, and long-term sustainability goals.



Independent Assurance Mechanisms

Third-party assessments and independent expert-led evaluations are undertaken across projects to ensure credibility, objectivity, and adherence to best-practice frameworks.



Risk Management & Internal Controls

Governance systems incorporate financial controls, audit mechanisms, and operational risk mitigation processes to ensure accountability and safeguard resources.



Responsible Partnerships

Responsible partnerships are central to our approach, with structured collaboration across corporates, government institutions and ecosystem partners. These partnerships help align interventions with public systems, leverage complementary expertise and resources, and enable responsible, transparent and scalable implementation.



Values-Driven Conduct

Organisational decision-making is anchored in core values of integrity, empathy, accountability, and impact-first approach, embedded across leadership and field operations.



Transparency & Disclosures

The organisation maintains high standards of transparency through structured reporting of program outcomes, financial utilisation, and stakeholder communication.



Robust Monitoring & Evaluation Systems

Strengthened M&E architecture incorporating baseline-endline assessments, real-time tracking, and data-driven review mechanisms for continuous improvement.

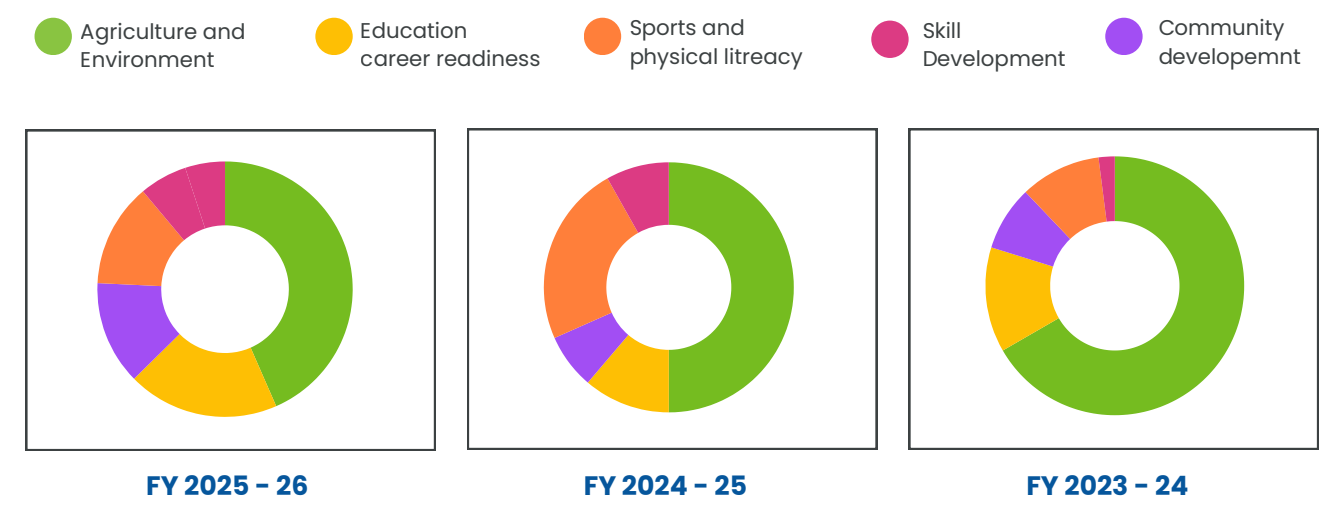


Stakeholder-Centric Governance

Programs are co-created with communities and other stakeholders, ensuring participatory planning, responsiveness to grassroots needs, and inclusive decision-making processes.

Financials

Percentage contribution for each thematic area to the overall funds received



Overall Projects' Value

Financial Year	Overall Projects Value (INR)	Program Implementation Expenditure (%)
2023-24	7,50,000,00	78%
2024-25	9,50,000,00	80%
2025-26	11,50,000,00	81%

Team

Roots Foundation is led by a diverse and dedicated team that combines youthful energy with seasoned experience. What makes our team of 200+ individuals unique is that no two people share the same background, qualification, or skillset. Each member brings a distinct perspective shaped by different disciplines, geographies, and lived experiences. This diversity fuels innovation, empathy, and adaptability across all our programs.

Our governance structure ensures transparency and accountability at every level. The Core Leadership Team and Board of Advisors provide strategic direction, while state and field teams drive on-ground execution with precision and purpose.

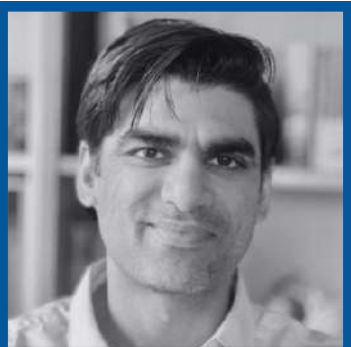
Advisory Board



A.P. Sinha



Nidhi Nautiyal



Ankit Bhatia

Founders



Ritwik Bahuguna



Ridhima Bahuguna

Vertical Leads



Trapti Moonat
Head - Growth



Vikas Gupta
Head - Agriculture
and Environment



Anirudh Singare
Head - Physical Literacy
and Sports



Sonia Singh
Manager - Education
and Skilling

Case Stories

Voices of change from across Roots Foundation's programs

AGRICULTURE AND ENVIORNMENT

Hemwanti Devi — The Harvest of Hope

Paseri Village, Jharkhand | Project Harit Samriddhi, supported by Coal India Limited

For years, Hemwanti Devi's small plot in Paseri yielded little, declining soil fertility and erratic rainfall kept her family's income uncertain. In 2023, she became one of the first farmers in her village to join Project Harit Samriddhi, setting up a mustard demonstration plot on her own land. Guided step by step by the Roots Foundation team, from reading her soil health report to adopting line sowing and the right dose of micronutrients, she pushed through poor early germination and self-doubt. The harvest changed everything: over two quintals of mustard from just half an acre, a yield she had never achieved before. Her success drew neighbours to a village-level training session she helped organise, turning one farmer's breakthrough into her community's renewed confidence in scientific farming.

“It's not just what I did. It's what I learned.” — Hemwanti Devi



AGRICULTURE AND ENVIORNMENT (CROP RESIDUE MANAGEMENT)

Mahender Kumar — From Conventional Practices to Climate-Smart Farming

Gadepan ki Jhopadiya, Kota, Rajasthan | Project Bhoomi, supported by Chambal Fertilisers

Mahender Kumar, 28, is the sole earning member of his six-member family, farming 19 bighas of land in Kota. Before joining Project Bhoomi, he burned crop residue after every harvest and left his fields fallow through the summer, a routine that steadily eroded soil health and kept cultivation costs high.

Through training, demonstrations and hands-on support from Roots Foundation, he adopted Direct Seeded Rice, scientific crop residue management, and a diversified cropping pattern that now includes maize, soybean, wheat and green fodder. He also began earning additional income by operating a harrow for residue management. The results: better soil moisture retention, reduced irrigation needs, lower cultivation costs, and a new income stream from green fodder sales.

“Today, I cultivate multiple crops, earn additional income, and have reduced my farming costs.” — Mahender Kumar

SPORTS AND PHYSICAL LITREACY

Harnoorpreet Kaur — A Fighting Spirit

Bhairupa Village, Bathinda, Punjab | Sports Lab,
supported by Hyundai Motor India Foundation

Harnoorpreet Kaur is 14, the daughter of a contract carpenter and a homemaker, growing up in a household with modest means but deep belief in her. In 2022, she joined a Sports Lab boxing centre under Coach Nirmal Singh, training twice a day around her school schedule. Her discipline has produced results few her age can match: two golds at the Bathinda District Championships, a gold at the Khedan Wadan State Tournament, a silver at the Open District Championship, and a gold and bronze at her School State Tournament. Beyond the medals, Sports Lab's career guidance and mentoring sessions helped her see boxing as a path to something bigger, a future where she represents India and shows other girls what's possible.

“Sports Lab gave Harnoorpreet the ring. She brought the fire.”



EDUCATION AND CAREER READINESS

A Student's Story — The Importance of Saving

Project LEAP, supported by Cummins India Ltd. and Samhita CGF

A student from the Parvati hill area walked two kilometres to school every day and often arrived late and exhausted, her family could not afford daily transport. During a Project LEAP life-skills session on saving, an activity sheet asked her to name something she wanted. She wrote: a bicycle. With her facilitator's help, she built a savings plan, cutting small daily expenses and redirecting her Diwali gift money, that shortened her twelve-month target to six. She pinned the plan above her study table and stuck to it. Months later, she arrived at school on a brand-new bicycle of her own: no longer tired, always early, and visibly more confident.

“Her twinkling eyes and confidence were proof of the importance of saving money.” — Project LEAP Facilitator

Testimonials

This is what our Partners have to say about us



Ashok Desai
Lead EKL CSR Foundation

On behalf of EKL CSR Foundation, we express our profound appreciation for the outstanding contributions of Roots Foundation in the agriculture training and skill development for farmers. Roots Foundation has been an essential training partner, educating farmers through basic training programs and advanced training in different states.



Shri. Lokesh Mishra
Deputy Commissioner,
Khunti

Utkarsh: Centre of Excellence for Sports, a collaboration between the Khunti District Administration and Roots Foundation, offers world-class training to young athletes. Despite being new, it has delivered exceptional results, enabling students to compete in prestigious tournaments like the Nehru Cup. The dedication of the coaches and the quality of training are commendable, ensuring these athletes will bring pride to Khunti in the future.



Saina Nehwal
Indian Badminton Player
and Olympic Medalist

This initiative (The Sports Lab Initiative) demonstrates a keen understanding of the needs of sportspersons, providing them with essential resources such as this fitness centre in Hisar. This program will go a long way in ensuring a budding athlete gets everything he needs - training, equipment, fitness lessons and recovery protocols.



Saurabh Sharma
General Manager
CSV HMIL

The professionalism, dedication, and expertise Roots brought to the initiatives made a significant difference, and we truly value the synergy we built. Sports Lab is a unique project where Roots Foundation has served as our partner from concept to the implementation stages, also creating measurable impact on the ground.



Recognitions

Our efforts have been appreciated time and again.



Indian CSR Awards
2023



INDIA donates,
2023



BCC&I Social Conclave, 2nd
Edition



Chambal Fertilizers & Chemicals Ltd.
(CFCL),
Samvartika 7th Edition 2023



BCC&I Social Conclave, 3rd
Edition



TheCSRUniverse,
2024



World CSR Day, North
India
Leadership Awards, 2024



CSR Times National
CSR & ESG Award, 2026

Our Partners

At Roots Foundation, partnerships are the cornerstone of every initiative we undertake. We believe that sustainable impact is achieved when communities, corporations, governments, and knowledge institutions work together toward shared goals.

Over the years, we have partnered with leading corporate organisations, public sector bodies, and development experts who share our commitment to inclusive, scalable, and measurable impact.











Let's collaborate to drive measurable impact together.

We are committed to being a research-driven implementation organization. By combining data, expertise, and grassroots action, we create sustainable change where it matters the most.



Roots Foundation India



Roots Foundation



rootsfoundation.india